14.12 Accidental Hypothermia*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Found outdoors in cold weather, drowsy **Objective** • Core temperature 31 °C • Not shivering • Slurred speech	**ACTUAL** Decreased body temperature related to prolonged cold exposure as evidenced by core temperature 31 °C and drowsiness.	• Core temperature rises about 1–2 °C an hour, per protocol.	• Remove wet clothing and handle her gently. • Rewarm actively from outside: warm blankets, forced-air warmer. • Give warmed IV fluids as prescribed. • Monitor core temperature continuously.	• Goal reached when rewarming proceeds safely.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • HR 42/min • J (Osborn) waves on ECG • BP 90/50 mmHg	**ACTUAL** Ineffective peripheral tissue perfusion related to hypothermia-induced bradycardia and dysrhythmias as evidenced by bradycardia and hypotension.	• Rhythm and BP stable during rewarming.	• Keep her on continuous ECG monitoring. • Have the defibrillator ready. • Move her gently, since rough handling can trigger ventricular fibrillation.	• Met while the rhythm is stable.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Being rewarmed • Fluid shifts	**RISK** Risk for impaired water-electrolyte balance as evidenced by risk factors: rewarming and fluid shifts (potassium changes).	• Potassium and glucose stay normal during rewarming.	• Check potassium and glucose during rewarming. • Replace as ordered.	• Achieved if values remain normal.

*References for this care plan: [10], [35], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.